Figure 2.3 illustrates one of the earliest experimental unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs), developed under A. M. Low in the United Kingdom during World War I. Designed as a radio-controlled, pilotless aircraft, the Aerial Target featured a lightweight wooden airframe, a front-mounted propeller driven by a small piston engine, and basic control surfaces operated through radio-transmitted signals. It was intended for defensive missions, particularly to intercept enemy zeppelins, and served as a proof of concept for remotely controlled powered flight. Although its limited range and stability prevented operational deployment, the Aerial Target marked a historic breakthrough in aviation technology, establishing the core principles of radio-guided control that would later evolve into modern UAV systems.



Figure 2.3 The Aerial Target (1916) – the world's first radio-controlled unmanned Aircraft.⏎

2.6.2.2 Kettering Bug (1918)

The Kettering Bug (1918), developed by Charles F. Kettering in the United States, was one of the most remarkable and ambitious projects in early